MSME Editorial Filter — Rule Sheet

Printable reference for the Stage-1 editorial judge (Jev). Generated 08 Oct 2026 · model jev-latest · gate threshold 0.85 · accept (weighted) threshold 60.0. Gates are evaluated in order (fail-fast): any gate at or above its threshold routes to REJECT, or to EDITOR REVIEW for the defamation/political review gates. If no gate fires, the weighted score of the criteria decides (≥ 60.0 = ACCEPT).

HARD GATES — any at/above its threshold decides

G1 · Not SME-relevant

G1 · not_sme_relevant — “Not SME-relevant” | type: noul | threshold: 0.85 | fires → REJECT

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is this submission not relevant to SMEs or the wider business ecosystem — for example, does it lack an SME, policy, financing, trade, technology, workforce or market-access angle?*

TRUE	Off-topic for an SME/business audience: consumer, lifestyle, entertainment, celebrity or sports content aimed at the general public; self-promotional company news with no sector or ecosystem bearing (internal awards, office moves, personal milestones, venue/product plugs); personal-finance, academic/medical research, or product reviews unrelated to running an SME.
FALSE	Relevant: affects how SMEs operate, earn, compete or comply — financing/capital access, government policy & regulation, tax, trade & exports, market access, digitalisation/technology, talent & workforce, supply chain/logistics, cost of doing business; industry or sector development with an SME angle. Factual government policy counts (partisan politics is a separate gate).

G2 · Single-company / no wider value

G2 · no_wider_value — “Single-company / no wider value” | type: noul | threshold: 0.85 | fires → REJECT

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is this a single-company or niche story that offers no wider development, lesson or perspective for other SME readers?*

TRUE	Focused on one company's own product, award, appointment or internal news with nothing the wider SME community can learn or use. Merely being 'about an SME' is not enough.
FALSE	Communicates a wider development, trend, lesson or perspective relevant to SMEs beyond the one sender.

G3 · Primarily commercial

G3 · is_it_commercial_intent — “Primarily commercial” | type: noul | threshold: 0.85 | fires → REJECT

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Does this submission primarily hard-sell a particular product or service — content centred on discounts, sales offers, product promotion or direct customer acquisition — rather than merely mention a product or service as part of a wider development relevant to SME readers?*

TRUE	Primarily hard-selling the sender's product or service: content centred on discounts, deals, pricing, sales offers, 'buy now' / 'register now' offers, product promotion, or direct customer acquisition — with little or no wider SME-relevant development.
FALSE	A product or service MAY be mentioned when it forms part of a wider development relevant to SME readers. Genuine news/editorial where the product, service or event is context within a wider SME-relevant development — INCLUDING a paid workshop/conference that carries substantive industry content (insights, strategies, speakers, agenda) — does NOT trigger this. An ordinary PR/business mention alone must not trigger it.

G4 · Not geographically relevant

G4 · not_geographically_relevant — “Not geographically relevant” | type: noul | threshold: 0.85 | fires → REJECT

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is this an overseas or international development that has no meaningful relevance to Malaysian SMEs, ASEAN business, trade or accessible markets?*

TRUE	Overseas corporate announcements, or foreign/general news, with no Malaysian, ASEAN or regional SME angle and no accessible-market or trade relevance.
FALSE	Malaysia-first content; or an international development with meaningful relevance to Malaysian SMEs, ASEAN business, trade or accessible markets — including a clearly transferable business impact on Malaysian/ASEAN SMEs. (Geographic scope only; topical SME relevance is the separate not_sme_relevant gate.)

G5 · Defamation risk

G5 · defamatory — “Defamation risk” | type: noul | threshold: 0.85 | fires → EDITOR REVIEW

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Does this contain potentially defamatory allegations, unsubstantiated accusations, obvious misinformation, discriminatory material, or other significant legal or reputational concerns?*

TRUE	Accusations/attacks without evidence; defamatory or discriminating claims; obvious misinformation;
FALSE	Clean factual announcement with attributed, evidence-based statements.

G6 · Political or advocacy

G6 · political — “Political or advocacy” | type: noul | threshold: 0.85 | fires → EDITOR REVIEW

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is this partisan/electoral politics, an advocacy piece that attacks, blames or campaigns against a party, leader or the government, or content that disparages religion or challenges Malaysia's royal institution — rather than factual government policy or a constructive policy proposal?*

TRUE	ANY of: (a) party campaign material, endorsements or partisan/electoral messaging (including partisan/bylined opinion); (b) advocacy that attacks, condemns, blames or campaigns against a political party, leader or the government, or otherwise takes a partisan side; (c) disparaging, mocking, insulting or attacking any religion, or otherwise inflaming religious sensitivities; (d) questioning, challenging or insulting Malaysia's royal institution (the Yang di-Pertuan Agong, the Sultans, the monarchy) or similar sedition-sensitive content. Merely mentioning religion or a ruler in a factual, respectful policy context does NOT count.
FALSE	Factual government policy/regulatory development, OR a constructive policy proposal or call from an industry body, association, company or SMEs (e.g. a Budget 2027 recommendation that asks the government to act) — with no partisan/electoral angle, no attack/blame on a party or leader, and no disparagement of religion or the royal institution.

SCORED CRITERIA — %-weights sum to 100; high NO% = ready

S1 · no_substance (17%)

S1 · no_substance | type: noul | weight: 17% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is there NOT enough factual material to construct a meaningful article from the submission alone — no clear development, context or supporting detail?*

TRUE	A bare announcement or pitch with almost no detail — e.g. 'Company X is excited to announce its new product' — nothing to build a story from.
FALSE	A clear development plus context and supporting detail — enough to write the article from the submitted material alone, WITHOUT adding outside facts.

S2 · not_identifiable (17%)

S2 · not_identifiable | type: noul | weight: 17% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Are the issuing organisation and quoted speakers NOT identifiable — no named organisation, and no named speakers or designations?*

TRUE	Anonymous or unattributed: the issuing organisation is not clearly named, and no speakers/quotes are named with designations.
FALSE	The issuing organisation is clearly identifiable — that alone is enough when no speakers are quoted. Where speakers/quotes are present, they are named with designations. (Sourcing of statistics/claims is a separate check.)

S3 · unattributed_claims (17%)

S3 · unattributed_claims | type: noul | weight: 17% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Are the statistics, rankings, performance or market claims NOT attributed — unsupported superlatives ('No.1', 'leading', 'fastest-growing') or bare numbers presented as fact, with no source in the submitted material?*

TRUE	A factual or market CLAIM is presented as fact with no attribution in the submission — e.g. 'No.1 in Malaysia', 'fastest-growing', or a bare statistic. A superlative that carries NO factual/market claim does NOT count.
FALSE	All figures, rankings and claims are contained in, or attributable to, the submitted material. Self-reported figures present in the submission count as attributed; this is NOT a fact-check.

S4 · not_current (8%)

S4 · not_current | type: noul | weight: 8% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is this significantly outdated with no new development (a long-past event re-sent)?*

TRUE	Stale — a clearly long-past event or date with no new information to make it current.
FALSE	Fresh — announced recently or upcoming; or evergreen insight that is still useful.

S5 · no_editorial_value (8%)

S5 · no_editorial_value | type: noul | weight: 8% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Overall, is there nothing an SME reader learns from this submission — the only meaningful takeaway being a sales message about the sender's product or service?*

TRUE	The net takeaway is a sales or registration message ('come buy / register / sign up / visit the booth'); an SME reader gains no useful editorial value from the piece as a whole.
FALSE	An SME reader learns something useful about SMEs, policy, markets or the economy — or gains a meaningful business update — even if a product or event is mentioned.

S6 · contact (8%)

S6 · contact | type: noul | weight: 8% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is there NO named, identifiable, contactable contact person/organisation?*

TRUE	No identifiable or contactable contact.
FALSE	Named person with role and contact details (or a body that names an official contact).

S7 · category_fit (8%)

S7 · category_fit | type: noul | weight: 8% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Does this fit NONE of the site's categories? The site categories are: Agriculture, Corporate, Government, Investment, Lifestyle, News, Opinion, Property, SME, Technology, Training & Education.*

TRUE	Fits none of the site categories — Agriculture, Corporate, Government, Investment, Lifestyle, News, Opinion, Property, SME, Technology, Training & Education — so it cannot be filed under any of them.
FALSE	Clearly fits at least one of the site categories: Agriculture, Corporate, Government, Investment, Lifestyle, News, Opinion, Property, SME, Technology, Training & Education.

S8 · not_sme_voice (17%)

S8 · not_sme_voice | type: noul | weight: 17% | good side = “no” = 1 − noul

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Does this submission fail to contribute useful knowledge, experience or perspective to the wider SME community — leaving only promotion of the sender's own product, service or business?*

TRUE	Pure promotion with no peer takeaway: product/service advertising, 'buy now' / pricing / sales offers, or company-only news other SMEs cannot learn or act on ('our product is the best').
FALSE	Contributes genuine value to the wider SME community — shares experience, lessons, market insight, opinion or a meaningful business update that other SMEs gain from. A product, service or the sender's own business MAY be mentioned as context; that alone must NOT lower this score.

CONTEXT QUESTION — shown to editors, never auto-routes

is_negative_or_attacking

is_negative_or_attacking | context only — not a gate, not weighted

Instruction (the question Jev answers): *Is this content negative, attacking or accusatory toward an identifiable person, organisation, political party or the government?*

TRUE	Criticism, accusation, attack or hostile framing of an identifiable target.
FALSE	Neutral or positive in tone.